MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume XIV | Issue II | Spring 2024



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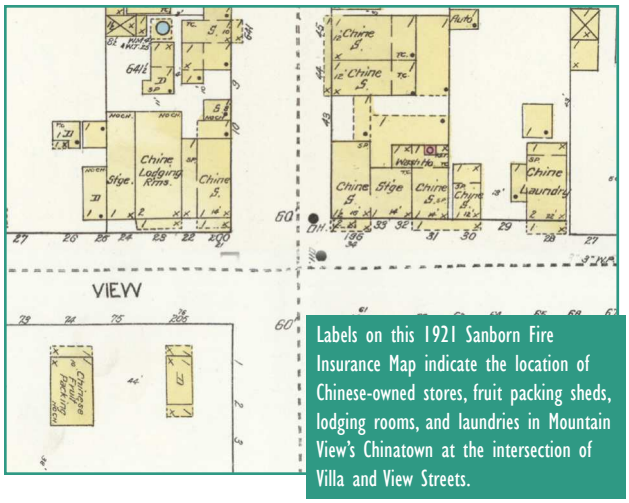
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Airmail Week in Mtn View.



Stories of Chinese Residents of Mtn. View - Then & Now

Our Spring 2024 Event

Chinese residents have been an important part of our community for over 150 years. Through all eras of the history of Mountain View, members of the Chinese community have played an instrumental role in shaping the city. Join us May 5 at the Senior Center at 2:00 p.m. when we will learn stories about early Chinese residents and current immigrants.



Labels on this 1921 Sanborn Fire Insurance Map indicate the location of Chinese-owned stores, fruit packing sheds, lodging rooms, and laundries in Mountain View's Chinatown at the intersection of Villa and View Streets.

Sunday, May 5, 2024 ● 2:00 to 4:00 p.m. ● Mtn. View Senior Center, 266 Escuela Avenue

REGISTER ONLINE: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

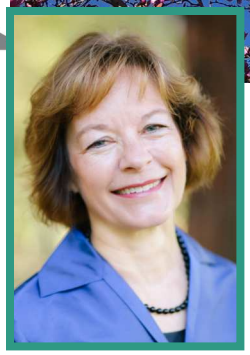
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Pamela Baird

President's Message

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

The Delight of Spring

The end of the rainy season sometimes makes me a bit melancholy. I enjoy the months of rain—the verdant green hills bring great pleasure. I like the cool weather—I get to wear wool, my favorite fabric. The exuberant blooming trees in white, yellow and pink make me wish that the trees would look like that all year round. Flowering beds of tulips, hyacinths, crocus and iris provide delight to my walks and runs in the community. The succulents in my garden are fat and happy as they store moisture for future use. The sweet fragrance of jasmine and the exuberant chirping of birds looking for love remind me that life is good.

After the dry months of the summer and fall I look forward to the arrival of the rain and seeing the cycle of greening and blooming start again. For most of us living in Silicon Valley, our livelihoods are not dependent on the seasons or the weather.

But for over eight decades, the prosperity of the Valley depended on crops—first wheat and hay and later stone fruit, wine grapes, berries and vegetables. Farmers, orchardists and ranchers relied on a mild climate with little chance of damaging frost. The "Valley of Hearts Delight" is ideally situated in an area with abundant artesian water, which provided the necessary moisture for growing crops and fruit in a Mediterranean climate, and less reliant on seasonal rain.

We are fortunate to have residents who can recall this agricultural past. To learn more about the stories of one of the most prolific areas of fruit production, the MVHA will be conducting a community outreach program to find the "Oldest Resident." See the short article on page 8 containing more information.

Enjoy the last days of the rainy season!

—Pamela





Mtn. View Mayor Pat Showalter (bottom right) and other guests at one of our monthly walking tours of historic Downtown Mountain View.

Outreach Updates

Downtown Walking Tours

The walking tours, which are offered on the fourth Sunday of most months, have had good participation from MV residents, nearby towns people and out of the area visitors. Starting at Centennial Plaza and ending near Castro and Church streets, the tour covers the history of MV, the stories of founding and early families, and historic buildings.

The tour lasts approximately 90 minutes. Participants vary between six and twelve people. Some are newcomers to MV and others are longtime residents, who sometimes offer additional information or recollections, which adds to the richness of the event. The cost to participate is $10 for MVHA members and $15 for nonmembers. Registration through EventBrite is required. More information can be found on our website.

Recently Mayor Pat Showalter and her husband Steve Longcor participated. Mayor Pat was interested to learn the prior locations of the buildings used as city hall. The tours are conducted by Pamela Baird, who is pleased to report that two participants offered a $20 "tip" for presenting such a great tour! You can learn more about upcoming tours on the MVHA website. The tours start at 2:00 p.m. To sign up visit: www.mountainviewhistorical.org/events

Stevenson School Field trip

Excited third graders raised their hands when queried by Pamela Baird, MVHA president, "Why do we study history?" The Stevenson Elementary School field trip visited the Mountain View Public Library on March 28 to learn about the history of Mountain View.

Using photos to show significant events, Pamela spoke about the people who have lived here before, Ohlone Indigenous people, Spaniards, Mexicans, Californios and settlers arriving after the Gold Rush. Afterwards the children were offered pages for coloring. Over 70 children participated.

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
MVHA Membership Chair

Happy Spring! During this season of renewal, please don't forget to renew your membership!!!

A warm welcome to our new members:

- Michael & Karen Van De Vanter
- James O'Brien
- Melanie Kaye
- Bill Danielson

THANK YOU, Doug and Debbie Kundrat for becoming lifetime members!!

If you have questions about membership please reach out: membership@mountainviewhistorical.org or call (323) 705-5650

Financial Report

By Melissa Rusch
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 3/31/24: $17,975.81
Checking Account Balance as of 12/31/2023:
$18,684.90

Key expenditures: Newsletter printing/mailing, booking fees for events, and promotional expenses.
Key income: Membership dues and walking tour fees.

Certificates of Deposit: $60,878.71



MVHA President Pamela Baird shares Mountain View history with third graders from Stevenson Elementary School during their field trip to the Mountain View Library

Winter Event Recap



Exploring EL CAMINO REAL

The Story of California's 1st Highway

In spite of blustery and rainy weather a large crowd showed up at the February 4 event at the Los Altos Library. To tie in with the temporary exhibit at the Los Altos History Museum the subject of the presentation was "Exploring El Camino Real- the story of California's 1st Highway".

Pamela Baird presented a detailed account of the early history of the origins of trails used by indigenous peoples, the arrival of and colonization by the Spanish and the transition to Mexican rule. The rich history of the effort to create the first state highway included the development of Mountain View from a farming community to a tech center.

Jordan Greahlish, Exhibits Specialist for the Los Altos History Museum, described the effort to chronicle history through the program that created the iconic El Camino bells. Women's groups helped create an interest in saving the many decaying missions.

Lastly IdaRose Slyvester, MVHA board member, created a fun look back at favorite businesses and restaurants located on El Camino Real. She even imagined, with the aid of AI, what a futuristic El Camino might look like many years from now.

Afterwards the attendees toured the special "El Camino Real: Changing California" exhibit at the Museum. The group enjoyed snacks, including special "US 101" cookies.



Right: MVHA Members Explore the Los Altos History Museum's El Camino Real Exhibit



Above: Director-at-Large IdaRose Sylvester presents at our Winter Event



Above: Jodan Greahlish, Pamela Baird, and their 101 Cookies!

Finding Your Family History

By Robert Cox
MVHA Vice President

In my last column, I mentioned that high-quality personal genealogy software is a must for anyone doing serious genealogy research. Since many packages are available for sale, it is useful to know some of the pros and cons of each before making your choice. I evaluated the three top options: Roots Magic, Family Historian, and Family Tree Maker.

Roots Magic (www.rootsmagic.com) is a popular program here in the USA. It runs on both Windows and Mac, has a free trial version, and has the lowest price of the three: $39.95. It is easy for beginners to get up to speed. It has some error checking capabilities and makes good use of color. However, I found that it made some serious mistakes merging family trees that I imported from another source. I would primarily recommend it for people who have a moderate interest in family history and are looking to take the next step to organize their data beyond stacks of old documents and file folders and who are looking for the lowest cost solution.

Family Historian (www.family-historian.co.uk) is a much better program and has received top reviews on many online genealogy web sites. It performs well on uploading genealogy data from other sources, although I found it did make a few mistakes while uploading my files. It sells for $69.95 and has a trial version. One disadvantage for American users is that it comes from the United Kingdom as so is more oriented toward that audience. For example, it features easy communication with MyHeritage and FindMyPast services, which are popular in Europe, but not Ancestry, which is based in the USA. It also has no Mac version.

Family Tree Maker (www.mackiev.com/ftm) is a bit more expensive at $79.95, but I found it is worth it. It is now my primary personal genealogy software. It was able to upload and merge my genealogy data without making errors, collecting it in a well-organized, extensible form. Users can perform backups before major changes. It integrates well with Ancestry and supports both Windows and Mac. The only downside is that it doesn't allow let you produce descendant trees while you are entering data. However, it does allow you to create descendant charts in its publishing features. It also does not prompt users for potential errors like birth date after death date and being married too young.





Mary Lo Zoglin in 1945 and at Mtn. View Mayor in 1999.

Mtn. View Family History Fun Fact!



The Swiss village of Glattfelden

Former Mountain View Mayor Mary Lou Zoglin (1928-2005) was born Mary Lou Glatfelter in York County, Pennsylvania. The daughter of high school teacher Stuart Glatfelter and his wife Ruth (Strickhouser) Glatfelter. Mary Lou took pride in and exemplified her Swiss ancestors' hard work and thriftiness, continuing as a Mountain View council member even as she battled cancer.



Stuart Glatfelter

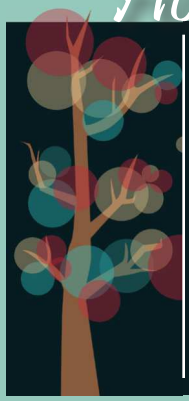
Casper Glattfelder (1709-1775) was Mary Lou's fourth great-grandfather and paternal immigrant ancestor. He immigrated to York County from Glattfelden, Switzerland. His last name was derived from the name of their ancestral town. All of Mary Lou's Glattfelder ancestors lived in York County, Pennsylvania.

Mary Lou left York County behind to attend Radcliffe College (now part of Harvard University). She met her future husband Dr. Stanton Zoglin while working as a translator and editor in New York City. They first moved to Nashville, TN, then Seattle, WA, and finally to Mountain View, where she and Stanton raised their three children: John, Katie, and Bill.

She was the author of "Power and Politics in the Community College," a work inspired by her 13 years as a member of the Foothill De-Anza Community College Board of Trustees. Stanton was a medical doctor who was chief of staff at El Camino Hospital.

As for Mary Lou's children, John serves on the El Camino District Healthcare District (ECHD) Board and works for Blue Cross/Blue Shield. Katie is the President of the Los Altos/Mountain View League of Women Voters and was a lawyer for local government. Bill is a general contractor in Reno, Nevada.

Honor Mtn. View's Oldest Living Resident



News about exceptional individuals who beat the actuarial tables by living over 100 years grab headlines around the world. "It's pure luck," said 111 year-old Englishman and Titanic survivor John Alfred Tinniswood. His case was verified by Guinness World Records this year. Of course, there's more to any success story. These super-agers are teaching lessons in longevity–practices both physical and psychological.

MVHA will honor our own oldest current resident this fall on or around the International Day of Older Persons (October 1). MVHA will collect stories about what happened during the lifetimes of our elders and show appreciation for their contributions.

Award details and search rules are posted on our website **www.mountainviewhistorical.org.** You can participate by completing and submitting the nomination form on behalf of yourself or someone else. Please take part in this community search. We are interested to see what insights and experiences will be gathered in the coming months.



Special Feature:
Mtn. View's Chinese History

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

Above: Yuen Lung Store on the corner of Villa and View streets in Mountain View's Chinatown

Although the history of Chinese people in the Mountain View area is not well documented, we still can learn a small portion of the early story through newspaper accounts, publications and documents.

The early Chinese immigrants to California worked in mining in the Sierras and then building railroads across the state. Almost all immigrants came from poor Cantonese speaking areas of southeast China. One of these areas is named Taishan, which calls itself the "First Home of the Overseas Chinese". An estimated half a million Chinese Americans are of Taishanese descent.



Photo of Yuen Lung

Many settled in San Francisco, where a vibrant "Chinatown" developed. Lesser known is a series of "Chinatowns" that were established in San Jose. The lush Santa Clara County drew Chinese workers to labor in the fields and orchards.

One such traveler was Yuen Lung, who arrived in Mountain View in 1879 at the age of 26. He was a farm laborer, who probably had heard that growing strawberries in Santa Clara County was a profitable endeavor for Chinese workers.

By 1884, Yuen was growing strawberries here, but needed to borrow money until the crop was harvested. He approached Jacob Mockbee, a local banker and businessman, for a loan of $150. Yuen repaid the loan (at a high interest rate) and thus started a long relationship between the two men.

With additional help from Mr. Mockbee, Yuen opened a merchandise store at the corner of View and Villa streets, at the center of what would be called "Chinatown" (even though several Japanese owned businesses were locate in the same small area). Yuen acted as a labor broker, store owner and fruit seller. Even though he suffered financial setbacks later in life, Yuen was a well-respected member of the entire community.

The 1882 Chinese Exclusion Act impacted the lives of the Chinese in Santa Clara County by prohibiting new immigrants and later further restricting their ability to travel, have access to legal rights and other limitations. Decades later the number of Chinese people had significantly dwindled to a tiny portion of the overall population.

Continued on next page



Above: Lunar New Year Parade on Castro Street in the 1980s.

One immigrant, Thomas Foon Chew, flourished despite the restrictions. As the son of a merchant, Thomas and his mother were able to immigrate to San Francisco in 1897. His father owned a small cannery. When the 1906 earthquake destroyed the business, it reopened in Alviso. Thomas joined with his father to expand the business, Bayside Cannery, where it flourished under his leadership.

A second cannery was opened in Mayfield (Palo Alto) in 1918 and a third in Isleton in 1919. Thomas was an innovator in the canning business, earning the nickname of "Mr. Asparagus." The company packed the tender stalks in square cans to prevent breakage of the delicate tips. Because of his untimely death at aged 42 the company's canneries were sold within five years. However, there are historic plaques in Alviso that document the history of the Bayside Cannery company.

When immigration laws were changed in the late 1940s a restricted number of Chinese people were allowed into the country. These early immigrants were Cantonese speakers, many from Hong Kong. Mountain View benefited from the new arrivals. Several Chinese restaurants were opened on Castro Street in the 1960s and 1970s. The nearby Moffett Air Station provided a good source of patronage, in addition to the local residents, many of whom had their favorite restaurants, such as Qui Hing Low, Andy's Chinese Restaurant, Golden Wok, New China Delight and Szechuan Gardens.



Mementos from Andy's Chinese Restaurant on display at the Mtn. View History Center



Above: Menu for the Golden Wok, located at 895 Villa Street (now Steins Beer Garden) for in the 1980s and 1990s.

A popular Lunar New year Parade was conducted on Castro Street from 1986-1998. The annual celebration attracted many observers, who watched lion dancers and cultural groups march and perform. By the early 1970s the draw of higher education brought Chinese people from Taiwan, Hong Kong and the mainland to study at Stanford and Berkeley. The development of Silicon Valley allowed these scholars to remain- to work and/or to develop their own companies. Other immigrants opened small businesses, such as insurance and law firms, markets and restaurants. Others became artists, film makers and philanthropists.

Today most Chinese in Mountain View and the surrounding areas are Mandarin speakers. To encourage participation in the community, the city of Mountain View offers the Chinese Language Civic Leadership Academy, a program designed to improve participants' understanding of local government and city services. The city also provides Chinese language translation services for many city meetings and programs. In 2023, the city held its first annual Lunar New Celebration at the Mountain View Community Center which featured traditional performances, crafts, games, community booths and food trucks.

Join us on May 5 for our quarterly event, where more information about the history of Chinese people will be presented. The 2:00 p.m. meeting will be held at the Mtn. View Senior Center.

MV Milestones in 2024



160th Anniversary: Train Service to Mountain View

In 1864 train service commenced on the peninsula. Near Castro Street in Mountain View was the location of the primary station for our city. The service from San Francisco to San Jose is the oldest continually run railroad west of the Mississippi. In 2024 Caltrain will launch Electrified service, another historic landmark in the evolution of rail in the Bay Area.

150th Anniversary: Mtn. View Fire Dept.

On April 1, 1874, the Mountain View Fire Department was formed when 50 of the town's civic-minded residents sat around a potbellied stove and a cracker barrel in the "Rogers & Rogers" Department Store and organized the first brigade for the then town of Mountain View. It is one of the oldest officially formed fire departments west of the Mississippi. On May 19, the Fire Department will have a parade along Castro Street and celebrations in front of City Hall.



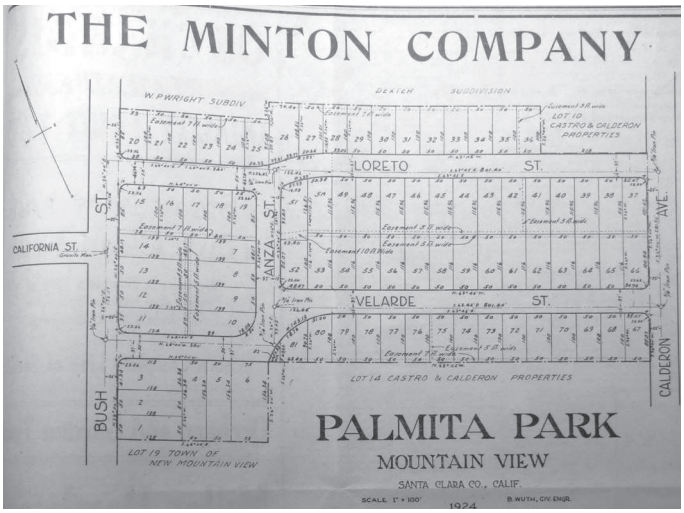
100th Anniversary: Yuba Street Bridge

This once vital section of our road system was built 100 years ago. Originally this bridge on the Alviso Road was one of only two crossings of Stevens Creek in Mountain View. The road connected the original Mountain View location at Grant and El Camino and the port town of Alviso, from where many agricultural products were shipped. When Highway 85 was planned the road was severed -one side is now Yuba Drive and the other Moorpark Way.

100th Anniversary: Wunderman House

When this house was constructed, the area was quite rural. Several years later the 7,200 square foot house was converted into a speakeasy and gambling center. A greyhound racetrack was added. After years of illicit activities, the property was confiscated by the federal government and later sold as a private residence. The Wunderman family has owned the property for over sixty years.





100th Anniversary: Loreto Street

Loreto Street will mark its 100th Anniversary this year. Beginning in January 1924, the Minton Lumber Company purchased and developed Loreto Street and a portion of Velarde, naming the subdivision Palmita Park after the signature little palms that it planted along the parkway. Nearly all of the original structures retain their 1920s character. The Mtn. ReView will feature an article about the anniversary in the next issue.

Airmail Week in Mtn. View

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President



To The Patrons Of
MOUNTAIN VIEW POST OFFICE

As you no doubt know, the Post Office Department has proclaimed the week of

May 15 to 21 1938

NATIONAL AIRMAIL WEEK

In keeping with the traditions of fine postal service as exemplified by the varied activities, besides regular post office work, your local post office, through the efforts of Postmaster Rollie Petty, has arranged with the co-operation of the Mountain View Air Port for an air mail flight from Mountain View, to Mills Field, where connections will be made for all air mail routes.

This flight will be made Thursday, May 19, 1938, from the Mountain View Airport, with Leroy R. Simon and Louis Lang, as pilots of the first flight of air mail from this city.

As this flight may have much historical significance, in future years, commemorating inauguration of a first flight, and perhaps, these envelopes may be sought after by collectors of first flight covers, giving the city of Mountain View an amount of favorable publicity that would be hard to duplicate, it is suggested that on May 19, 1938, all residents of this community avail themselves of the privilege of sending one air mail letter on that date.

An Air Mail letter on May 19 through the Mountain View post office may be an inspiration for someone to make this their future home.

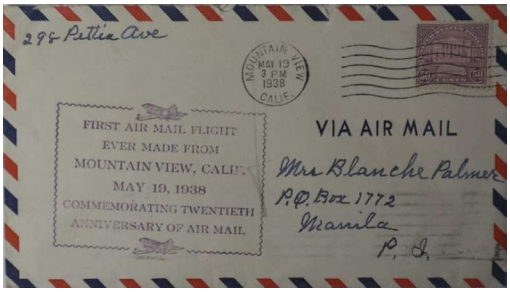
THE MOUNTAIN VIEW POST OFFICE EMPLOYEES INVITES YOUR COOPERATION IN MAKING THIS DAY A SUCCESSFUL ONE.

According to the American Air Mail Society, in 1938, Postmaster General James A. Farley and President Franklin Roosevelt created and proclaimed a week-long event to commemorate the 20th anniversary of the inauguration of US airmail service. They saw the event as an opportunity to gain wider support and usage of the Post Office Department's airmail service. The celebration week was preceded by the issue of a new $0.06 airmail stamp, the attractive bicolored eagle, Scott #C23. Farley asked that every US citizen send an airmail letter during the week. The slogan was "Receive To-morrow's mail today."



Mountain View participated in the nationwide celebration. On May 19 a plane piloted by Ted Simon and Louis Lang took off from the Mountain View Airport at 3:45 p.m. heading to Mills Field, where connections were made for all air mail routes. The Mountain View Register Leader newspaper noted that usually about a dozen pieces of mail were sent via air mail daily. Just a bit over 1,000 pieces of mail were posted that day by residents of the city, surpassing nearby Palo Alto on a per capita basis by many times over. With four times the population of Mountain View, Palo Alto sent only 1,558 pieces of mail.

In California alone, 4.5 million airmail letters and 3200 packages were posted on May 19. And just like the notice predicted, collectors have sought envelopes mailed on May 19. John Kostka, a Mountain view resident and history major student at San Jose State University, supplied a copy of an envelope that he saw listed on eBay in 2022. Unfortunately, he was unable to bid on the envelop, but did take a copy of the image shown below.



Today, the US Postal Service uses 140 domestic airports to fly six million pounds of mail each day.

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! You can also join/renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Membership is tax deductible to the extent permitted by law. The MVHA is a tax-exempt organization under Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), Tax ID 94-6115407.

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Household Annual Membership *$30/year*
- ☐ Individual Lifetime Membership *$300*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name(s): _____

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Thank you!

SPRING/SUMMER

May 5
Sunday, 2:00 to 4:00 p.m.
MVHA Spring Event & Meeting
Mtn.View Senior Center, 266 Escuela Ave.
See page 1 for more info!

April 29 & June 3
Wednesday, 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.
MVHA Board Meetings
Virtual Zoom meeting
All interested members welcome to attend! Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org for log-in

May 26 & June 23
Sunday, 2:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.
Downtown Walking Tours
Centennial Plaza, 600 W. Evelyn Ave, Mtn.View
Details at: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

Save the Date!
August 4
Sunday, 2:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m.
MVHA Summer Meeting
Mtn.View Community Center, Rengstorff Park
More details in our Summer Newsletter!

Looking Back: Images from the Archives



From the 1880s until the 1940s, the intersection of Villa and View streets was the heart of Mountain View's Asian-immigrant community. Known then as Chinatown, this compact district served the local immigrant community from China, Japan and other Asian countries. By the 1940s, many of the buildings in Chinatown were in disrepair and condemned. This photo shows a large fire on April 1, 1946 that destroyed many of the buildings in Chinatown. Over 60 people had to be evacuated, but no one was injured. Many members of the then volunteer fire department helped to extinguish the flames. Join us on May 5 to learn about the long history of the Chinese community in Mountain View, see page 1 for more info.

EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
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